

TASK 5 - Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A – Case Study

Cybercrime Case Study: Phishing Attack

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers attempt to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trustworthy entity. A common scenario involves a student receiving an email that appears to be from their bank or a popular online service, claiming that their account needs urgent verification.

The email usually contains a link that redirects the user to a fake website designed to look identical to the original. When the user enters their login credentials or financial details, the information is captured by the attacker. In some cases, the attacker may also ask for OTPs to complete fraudulent transactions.

Students and young adults are often targeted because they frequently use online services and may not always verify the authenticity of such messages. The consequences of phishing attacks can include financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to personal accounts.

This type of cybercrime spreads mainly through emails, messages, or social media platforms, making it essential for users to remain cautious and verify sources before sharing any sensitive information.

Part B – Prevention Checklist

1. Stay Safe Online – Checklist

- Always verify the sender before clicking on links or downloading attachments
- Do not share OTPs, passwords, or personal information with anyone
- Use strong and unique passwords for different accounts
- Enable two-factor authentication wherever possible
- Avoid clicking on suspicious or unknown links

2. UPI / Financial Safety

- Never approve unknown UPI payment requests
- Double-check UPI IDs and receiver details before sending money

3. Reporting

- Report cybercrime at: <https://cybercrime.gov.in>
- Call **Helpline: 1930** for financial fraud assistance

